SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

19 July 2022 · Shift 3

68 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 32 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 24 questions

Q.1

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Existing or happening in the same time period

(A) Inbred
(B) Exemplary
(C) Contemporary
(D) Cosmopolitan

Q.2

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Confiscated

(A) Seized
(B) Marinated
(C) Acquitted
(D) Liberated

Q.3

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Details of the housing / services and allowances / has not been announced yet

(A) services and internment
(B) Details of the housing
(C) No error
(D) has not been announced yet

Q.4

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. After a long _____, she finally answered my question.

(A) pass
(B) posse
(C) paws
(D) pause

Q.5

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. The UAE, along with other/ Gulf states, has been being/ making friendly overtures to Iran.

(A) The UAE along with other
(B) No error
(C) Gulf states has been being
(D) making friendly overtures to Iran

Q.6

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Every other facility can only "be enjoyed with" the benefit of good health.

(A) being enjoying with
(B) No improvement required
(C) been enjoyed with
(D) enjoying for

Q.7

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Robust

(A) Agile
(B) Healthy
(C) Weak
(D) Strong

Q.8

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Sprightly

(A) Lethargic
(B) Enthusiastic
(C) Durable
(D) Spiteful

Q.9

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Indafatigable
(B) Indafetigable
(C) Indefatigable
(D) Indefetigable

Q.10

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. A leopard cannot change its spots

(A) It is possible to complete a tedious job
(B) being ready to do anything is not common
(C) Working with full devotion.brings results
(D) It is impossible to change who you are

Q.11

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. In some institutions, additional teaching / assistants will hired to / teach high school students.

(A) No error
(B) In some institutions, additional teaching
(C) assistants will hired to
(D) teach high school students

Q.12

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A room in a public building where outdoor clothes or luggage may be left

(A) Cemetery
(B) Cloakroom
(C) Courtyard
(D) Hangar

Q.13

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Satiate

(A) Pamper
(B) Culminate
(C) Satisfy
(D) Agitate

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The skill of execution is viewed as inseparable from art, and mastery of technical problems is a _____ for producing expressive interpretations.

(A) parasite
(B) premonition
(C) percussion
(D) precondition

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The prisoners made an elaborate plan to escape _____ the jail.

(A) in
(B) by
(C) for
(D) from

Q.16

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I can't _____ this pain anymore.

(A) bier
(B) boor
(C) bear
(D) beer

Q.17

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. I can neither punish him nor reward him for "which he have done."

(A) what he done
(B) No improvement required
(C) what he has done
(D) which he has did

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I can't fit this teddy bear in my almirah. It is so _____.

(A) judicious
(B) liberal
(C) gigantic
(D) petite

Q.20

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Heart and soul

(A) Quickly
(B) Suddenly
(C) Completely
(D) Loudly

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Scientists (1) _____ Oxford University say their experimental coronavirus vaccine (2) _____ been shown in an early trial to prompt a protective immune response in hundreds of people who got the shot. British researchers first began testing the vaccine in April in about 1,000 people, half of (3) _____ got the experimental vaccine. Such early trials are usually designed only to (4) _____ safety, but in this case, experts were also looking to see what kind of immune response was (5) _____ .

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) to
(B) in
(C) on
(D) at

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Scientists (1) _____ Oxford University say their experimental coronavirus vaccine (2) _____ been shown in an early trial to prompt a protective immune response in hundreds of people who got the shot. British researchers first began testing the vaccine in April in about 1,000 people, half of (3) _____ got the experimental vaccine. Such early trials are usually designed only to (4) _____ safety, but in this case, experts were also looking to see what kind of immune response was (5) _____ .

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) was
(B) had
(C) have
(D) has

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Scientists (1) _____ Oxford University say their experimental coronavirus vaccine (2) _____ been shown in an early trial to prompt a protective immune response in hundreds of people who got the shot. British researchers first began testing the vaccine in April in about 1,000 people, half of (3) _____ got the experimental vaccine. Such early trials are usually designed only to (4) _____ safety, but in this case, experts were also looking to see what kind of immune response was (5) _____ .

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) whose
(B) what
(C) whom
(D) which

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Scientists (1) _____ Oxford University say their experimental coronavirus vaccine (2) _____ been shown in an early trial to prompt a protective immune response in hundreds of people who got the shot. British researchers first began testing the vaccine in April in about 1,000 people, half of (3) _____ got the experimental vaccine. Such early trials are usually designed only to (4) _____ safety, but in this case, experts were also looking to see what kind of immune response was (5) _____ .

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) elevate
(B) criticise
(C) dictate
(D) evaluate

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Scientists (1) _____ Oxford University say their experimental coronavirus vaccine (2) _____ been shown in an early trial to prompt a protective immune response in hundreds of people who got the shot. British researchers first began testing the vaccine in April in about 1,000 people, half of (3) _____ got the experimental vaccine. Such early trials are usually designed only to (4) _____ safety, but in this case, experts were also looking to see what kind of immune response was (5) _____ .

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) reduced
(B) provoked
(C) sheltered
(D) lessened

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. No G is H. II. Some R are G. Conclusions: I. Some H are not G. II. All H are R.

(A) Only conclusion II follows
(B) Only conclusion I follows
(C) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(D) Both conclusions I and II follow

Q.2

In a certain code language, 'DISK' is written as 'SIKD', and 'MINE' is written as 'NIEM'. How will 'BOLD' be written in that language?

(A) BLOD
(B) DOLB
(C) BDOL
(D) LODB

Q.3

In a certain code language, if phone is called laptop, laptop is called kettle, kettle is called refrigerator, refrigerator is called charger, and charger is called cooler, then what is used to store food?

(A) Charger
(B) Laptop
(C) Refrigerator
(D) Kettle

Q.6

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 56, 111, 221, 441, 881, ?

(A) 1651
(B) 1661
(C) 1761
(D) 1781

Q.7

If 'Red' is called 'Blue', 'Blue' is called 'White', 'White' is called 'Black', 'Black' is called 'Pink', and 'Pink' is called 'Orange', then what is the colour of milk?

(A) Pink
(B) Orange
(C) White
(D) Black

Q.8

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers in the given set. (146, 102, 58)

(A) (164, 120, 56)
(B) (150, 106, 62)
(C) (168, 114, 70)
(D) (152, 108, 84)

Q.9

Select the option that is related to the fifth alphanumeric-cluster in the same way as the second alphanumeric-cluster is related to the first alphanumeric-cluster and the fourth alphanumeric-cluster is related to the third alphanumeric-cluster. MNO13 : QRS17 :: PQR16 : TUV20 :: STU19 : ?

(A) WXY22
(B) VWX23
(C) WXY23
(D) VWX22

Q.10

By interchanging the two numbers 20 and 36, which of the following equations will be correct? I. 55 + 42 – 36 × 20 ÷ 9 = 17 II. 20 ÷ 2 × 36 + 81 – 41 = 400

(A) Only I
(B) Only II
(C) Both I and II
(D) Neither I nor II

Q.11

Select the letter-cluster that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. GAM, DCJ, AEG, XGD, ?

(A) VJA
(B) UIA
(C) VIA
(D) UJA

Q.13

Among five friends Aman, Baman, Chaman, Karan and Tapan, Chaman is older than only one friend. Tapan is older than Karan. Only two persons are older than Karan. Baman is older than Tapan. Who is the youngest among all the friends?

(A) Aman
(B) Chaman
(C) Tapan
(D) Karan

Q.14

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 68 : 4 :: 130 : 5 :: 350 : ?

(A) 6
(B) 8
(C) 9
(D) 7

Q.15

6 persons A, B, C, D, E and F are sitting in a row facing north (not necessarily in the same order). A is the immediate neighbour of D and F. F is the immediate neighbour of E and A. B is in the second position from the right end. If D is not at any of the ends, then how many persons are sitting towards the left of D?

(A) 2
(B) 1
(C) 5
(D) 3

Q.16

Which of the numbers (not digits) should be interchanged in the given equation to make it mathematically correct? $4 + 6 \times 3 - 5 \div 2 = 16$

(A) 5 and 6
(B) 4 and 6
(C) 2 and 3
(D) 5 and 3

Q.17

Select the option that will replace the question mark (?) in the given series. 77, 158, 207, 232, 241, ?

(A) 242
(B) 243
(C) 244
(D) 240

Q.18

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. RIDE : EIDR :: IDLE : EDLI :: LAMP : ?

(A) ALPM
(B) PAML
(C) PMAL
(D) MPAL

Q.20

Select the option that is related to the third word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word. Night Blindness : Vitamin A :: Beri Beri : ?

(A) Vitamin D
(B) Vitamin C
(C) Vitamin B
(D) Vitamin A

Q.21

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statement I: Some pastas are pizzas. No pizza is a burger. Statement II: All burgers are nachos. Conclusion I: Some pasta being nacho is a possibility. Conclusion II: All pizza being nacho is a possibility.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follows.
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.
(C) Only conclusion I follows.
(D) Only conclusion II follows.

Q.22

In a certain code language, 'HOLA' is coded as '16', and 'GRABY' is coded as '25'. How will 'SIX' be coded in that language?

(A) 6
(B) 12
(C) 18
(D) 9

Q.24

Among seven friends P, Q, R, S, T, U and V; U is taller than only three other friends. R is tallest among all friends. T is taller than U. Q is taller than only one person. Only two persons are taller than P. V is taller than Q. Who is the shortest among all the friends?

(A) S
(B) U
(C) V
(D) P

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

What are the projections of varying lengths protruding out of an amoeba's body, which can appear and disappear, known as?

(A) Contractile vacuole
(B) Paramecium
(C) Pseudo vacuole
(D) Pseudopodia

Q.2

What is the minimum age to become Rajya Sabha member?

(A) 20 years
(B) 25 years
(C) 35 years
(D) 30 years

Q.3

Who among the following former governors of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) was appointed as the Vice-President of The Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) in January 2022?

(A) Urjit Patel
(B) Raghuram Rajan
(C) YV Reddy
(D) D Subbarao

Q.4

Who among the following musicians has won the Bharat Ratna Award?

(A) Ram Narayan
(B) Ustad Bismillah Khan
(C) Hariprasad Chaurasia
(D) Ustad Ali Akbar Khan

Q.5

By maternal descent, Mughals were descendants of ?

(A) Timur
(B) Alexander
(C) Genghis Khan
(D) Galba

Q.6

Gochi festival is an Indian festival majorly celebrated in _____.

(A) Chhattisgarh
(B) Goa
(C) Himachal Pradesh
(D) Karnataka

Q.7

Who set up the Asiatic Society of Bengal?

(A) James Mill
(B) William Jones
(C) Robert Clive
(D) Warren Hastings

Q.8

In which year was the first ICC men's Cricket World Cup played?

(A) 1977
(B) 1974
(C) 1976
(D) 1975

Q.9
Which of the following factors does NOT affect the formation of soil?

(A) Climate
(B) Parent material
(C) Landslides
(D) Topography

Q.10
The Barabati Fort is situated in the city of.

(A) Guwahati
(B) Cuttack
(C) Madurai
(D) Raipur

Q.11
Which of the following elements of the periodic table has atomic number 1?

(A) Hydrogen
(B) Cobalt
(C) Copper
(D) Nitrogen

Q.12
'Ace Against Odds' is the autobiography of which of the following persons?

(A) Vijay Amritraj
(B) Sania Mirza
(C) Leander Paes
(D) Mahesh Bhupathi

Q.13
Which famous Bharatanatyam dancer was awarded with the Padma Bhushan in 1957 and Padma Vibhushan in 1977? Bengali film director Satyajit Ray made a documentary on her.

(A) Ileana Citaristi
(B) Tanjore Balasaraswati
(C) Saroj Khan
(D) Kumari Kamala

Q.14
Zoroaster was a/an _____ prophet.

(A) Indian
(B) Chinese
(C) British
(D) Iranian

Q.15
The word agriculture is derived from the Latin words ager and culture. What does 'ager' mean?

(A) Rocks
(B) Soil
(C) Water
(D) Plants

Q.16
Who founded Shantiniketan near Bolpur on 22 December 1901?

(A) Dr Rajendra Prasad
(B) Rabindranath Tagore
(C) Durgabai Deshmukh
(D) Gopal Krishna Gokhale

Q.17
What is the total number of India's neighbouring countries?

(A) Twelve
(B) Six
(C) Eight
(D) Nine

Q.18
Which Indian city will host the 2023 International Olympic Committee session?

(A) Chennai
(B) Pune
(C) Mumbai
(D) Bengaluru

Q.19

Which state has the highest reserves of graphite in India, as of April 2022?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Arunachal Pradesh
(C) Karnataka
(D) Chhattisgarh

Q.20

Which of the following is NOT a feature of parliamentary government in India?

(A) Membership of the ministers in the legislature,
(B) Undissolvable lower house
(C) Presence of nominal and real executives
(D) Collective responsibility of the executive to the legislature

Q.21

In India, the second census of the 21st century was conducted in _____.

(A) 2014
(B) 2011
(C) 2004
(D) 2009

Q.22

Who among the following legendary Kathak dancers passed away in January 2022?

(A) Pandit Birju Maharaj
(B) Pandit Lachhu Maharaj
(C) Pandit Ravi Shankar
(D) Pandit Durga Lal

Q.23

Baking soda is the common name of _____.

(A) citric acid
(B) tartaric acid
(C) sodium bicarbonate
(D) ammonium hydroxide

Q.24

Since which year has the AFSPA been started?

(A) 1949
(B) 1952
(C) 1958
(D) 1955

Q.25

Jagoi and Cholom are the two main divisions of ?

(A) Bharatanatyam
(B) Odissi
(C) Manipuri
(D) Kathak

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(B)**

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(B)**
Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**
Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(D)**
Q.24 **(A)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (C) Contemporary

'Contemporary' means existing or happening at the same time. 'Inbred' means innate or born of close relatives, and 'cosmopolitan' means drawn from many countries.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Seized

To 'confiscate' is to take something away by authority: 'seized'. 'Acquitted' and 'liberated' mean set free.

Q.3 · Answer (D) has not been announced yet

The plural subject 'Details' needs a plural verb: 'Details of the housing, services and allowances have not been announced yet.' (The options misprint the second part as 'services and internment'; that part has no error.)

Q.4 · Answer (D) pause

A 'pause' is a short stop or silence. 'Pass', 'posse' and 'paws' sound alike but do not fit the sense.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Gulf states has been being

'Has been being making' mixes two forms; the present perfect continuous is 'has been making': 'The UAE, along with other Gulf states, has been making friendly overtures to Iran.' The singular 'has' is right, as a phrase with 'along with' does not change the subject's number.

Q.6 · Answer (B) No improvement required

After the modal 'can' the passive is 'be' + past participle, so 'can only be enjoyed with' is already correct.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Weak

'Robust' means strong and healthy; its opposite is 'weak'. 'Healthy' and 'strong' are its synonyms.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Lethargic

'Sprightly' means lively and full of energy; its opposite is 'lethargic', sluggish and without energy.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Indefatigable

The correct spelling is 'indefatigable', meaning never tiring.

Q.10 · Answer (D) It is impossible to change who you are

'A leopard cannot change its spots' means that a person's basic nature does not change.

Q.11 · Answer (C) assistants will hired to

The future passive needs 'be': 'additional teaching assistants will be hired to teach high school students'.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Cloakroom

A cloakroom is a room where coats, bags and luggage can be left. A hangar houses aircraft, and a courtyard is an open space enclosed by walls or buildings.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Satisfy

To 'satiate' is to satisfy a hunger or desire fully: 'satisfy'.

Q.14 · Answer (D) precondition

A 'precondition' is something that must exist before something else can happen: mastery of technique comes before expressive interpretation.

Q.15 · Answer (D) from

One escapes 'from' a place: 'to escape from the jail'.

Q.16 · Answer (C) bear

To 'bear' pain is to endure it. 'Bier', 'boor' and 'beer' sound alike but do not fit.

Q.17 · Answer (C) what he has done

'What' (the thing that) is needed after 'for', not 'which', and the singular 'he' takes 'has': 'I can neither punish him nor reward him for what he has done.'

Q.18 · Answer (C) gigantic
A teddy bear too big for the almirah is 'gigantic', that is huge. 'Petite' means small, the opposite.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Completely
To do something 'heart and soul' is to do it completely, with all one's energy and enthusiasm.

Q.21 · Answer (D) at
'At' goes with a place of work or study: 'Scientists at Oxford University'.

Q.22 · Answer (D) has
The scientists 'say' it now, so the present perfect is needed, and the singular subject 'vaccine' takes 'has': 'has been shown'.

Q.23 · Answer (C) whom
After the preposition 'of', the object form 'whom' refers to the people: 'half of whom got the experimental vaccine'.

Q.24 · Answer (D) evaluate
Early trials are designed to 'evaluate', that is assess, the vaccine's safety.

Q.25 · Answer (B) provoked
The experts wanted to see what immune response the vaccine 'provoked', that is produced; 'reduced', 'lessened' and 'sheltered' do not fit.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (B) Only conclusion I follows
'No G is H' also means no H is G, so some H are not G: I follows. No statement links H with R, so II does not follow.

Q.2 · Answer (D) LODB
The letters in places 3, 2, 4 and 1 are written in that order: DISK → S I K D and MINE → N I E M. So BOLD → L O D B: LODB.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Charger
Food is stored in a refrigerator, and a refrigerator is called 'charger'.

Q.6 · Answer (C) 1761
Each term is twice the one before, minus 1: 56 × 2 – 1 = 111, 111 × 2 – 1 = 221, and so on, so 881 × 2 – 1 = 1761.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Black
Milk is white, and 'White' is called 'Black'.

Q.8 · Answer (B) (150, 106, 62)
Each number is 44 less than the one before: 146 – 44 = 102 and 102 – 44 = 58. Likewise 150 – 44 = 106 and 106 – 44 = 62.

Q.9 · Answer (C) WXY23
Each letter moves 4 places forward and the number, the first letter's place in the alphabet, rises by 4: MNO13 → QRS17 and PQR16 → TUV20. So STU19 → WXY23.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Both I and II
After interchanging: I. 55 + 42 – 20 × 36 ÷ 9 = 55 + 42 – 80 = 17; II. 36 ÷ 2 × 20 + 81 – 41 = 360 + 81 – 41 = 400. Both are correct.

Q.11 · Answer (B) UIA
The first letters move back 3 (G, D, A, X, U), the second forward 2 (A, C, E, G, I) and the third back 3 (M, J, G, D, A): UIA.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Aman
Only two are older than Karan, so Karan is third; Tapan, older than Karan, is second and Baman, older than Tapan, first. Chaman, older than only one, is fourth, which leaves Aman the youngest.

Q.14 · Answer (D) 7
Each first number is the cube of its pair plus the pair itself: $4^3 + 4 = 68$ and $5^3 + 5 = 130$. Likewise $7^3 + 7 = 343 + 7 = 350$.

Q.15 · Answer (D) 3
A sits between D and F, and F between A and E, so the four sit as E F A D or D A F E. B is fifth from the left, so the four take places 1 to 4, and as D is not at an end the row is E F A D B C. Three persons sit to the left of D.

Q.16 · Answer (A) 5 and 6
After interchanging 5 and 6: $4 + 5 \times 3 - 6 \div 2 = 4 + 15 - 3 = 16$.

Q.17 · Answer (A) 242
The differences are 81, 49, 25 and 9, the squares of 9, 7, 5 and 3. The next is $1^2 = 1$: 241 + 1 = 242.

Q.18 · Answer (B) PAML
The first and last letters swap places: RIDE → EIDR and IDLE → EDLI. So LAMP → PAML.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Vitamin B
Night blindness is caused by a lack of vitamin A, and beri-beri by a lack of vitamin B1 (thiamine), one of the B vitamins.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Both conclusions I and II follows.
No statement links pastas with nachos, so some pasta being nacho is possible: I follows. Pizzas are only kept out of burgers, so the nachos can still include every pizza: II follows too.

Q.22 · Answer (D) 9
Each word is coded as the square of its number of letters: HOLA (4) → 16 and GRABY (5) → 25. So SIX (3) → 9.

Q.24 · Answer (A) S
R is the tallest. Only two are taller than P, so P is third; U, taller than only three, is fourth, and T, taller than U, is second. Q is sixth and V, taller than Q, fifth, so S is the shortest.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Pseudopodia
Pseudopodia ('false feet') are temporary projections of an amoeba's cytoplasm, used to move and to capture food. A contractile vacuole expels excess water, and Paramecium is another protozoan.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 30 years
Under Article 84(b) a member of the Rajya Sabha (Council of States) must be at least 30 years old; for the Lok Sabha the minimum is 25.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Urjit Patel
In January 2022 Urjit Patel, RBI governor from September 2016 to December 2018, was named one of the AIIB's five vice-presidents, for a three-year term.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Ustad Bismillah Khan
Ustad Bismillah Khan, the shehnai maestro, received the Bharat Ratna in 2001. The other three, masters of the sarangi, the flute and the sarod, had not received it when the exam was held (July 2022).

Q.5 · Answer (C) Genghis Khan
Babur, the first Mughal emperor, descended from Timur on his father's side and from Genghis Khan, through Chagatai, on his mother's.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Himachal Pradesh
Gochi is celebrated in February in the Lahaul valley of Himachal Pradesh by families in which a son was born during the previous year.

Q.7 · Answer (B) William Jones
Sir William Jones founded the Asiatic Society in Calcutta in January 1784 to promote the study of Asia's history, languages and literature.

Q.8 · Answer (D) 1975
The first men's Cricket World Cup was held in England in 1975; West Indies beat Australia in the final at Lord's.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Landslides
Soil forms from parent material under the influence of climate, relief (topography), living organisms and time. A landslide moves soil and rock rather than forming soil.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Cuttack
The ruins of Barabati Fort, built by the medieval rulers of Odisha, stand in Cuttack on the bank of the Mahanadi, beside the Barabati Stadium.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Hydrogen
Hydrogen, the lightest element, has one proton in its nucleus, so its atomic number is 1. Nitrogen's is 7, cobalt's 27 and copper's 29.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Sania Mirza
'Ace Against Odds' (2016) is the autobiography of the tennis player Sania Mirza.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Tanjore Balasaraswati
Tanjore Balasaraswati received the Padma Bhushan in 1957 and the Padma Vibhushan in 1977; Satyajit Ray's documentary 'Bala' (1976) is about her.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Iranian
Zoroaster (Zarathustra), the founder of Zoroastrianism, was a prophet of ancient Iran (Persia); the Parsis of India follow his faith.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Soil
NCERT explains 'agriculture' as coming from the Latin 'ager' (or 'agri'), meaning soil, and 'culture', meaning cultivation.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Rabindranath Tagore
Rabindranath Tagore opened his school at Santiniketan, near Bolpur in West Bengal, on 22 December 1901; it grew into Visva-Bharati. The ashram there had been set up by his father, Debendranath Tagore, in 1863.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Nine
SSC's key gives nine, the neighbours NCERT's Class 9 geography names: the seven countries that share a land border with India (Pakistan, Afghanistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh) and the two island countries across the sea, Sri Lanka and Maldives. Other lists count differently, depending on what is taken as a neighbour.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Mumbai
In February 2022 the IOC chose Mumbai to host its 2023 session; the 141st IOC Session was held there in October 2023, the first in India since New Delhi in 1983.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Arunachal Pradesh
SSC's key gives Arunachal Pradesh, which holds the largest share of India's graphite resources (about 36% in the National Mineral Inventory of 1 April 2020). In the narrower 'reserves' category (proved and probable) the Indian Bureau of Mines puts Tamil Nadu first, but it is not among the options.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Undissolvable lower house
The President can dissolve the Lok Sabha on the advice of the council of ministers, and a dissolvable lower house is itself a feature of the parliamentary system. The other three are features of it.

Q.21 · Answer (B) 2011
Census 2011, India's 15th census, was the second of the 21st century, after 2001.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Pandit Birju Maharaj
Pandit Birju Maharaj, the Kathak master of the Lucknow gharana, died in Delhi in January 2022, aged 83.

Q.23 · Answer (C) sodium bicarbonate
Baking soda is sodium hydrogencarbonate (sodium bicarbonate), $NaHCO_3$; washing soda is sodium carbonate.

Q.24 · Answer (C) 1958
The Armed Forces (Special Powers) Act was passed in 1958, first for disturbed areas of Assam and Manipur; it gives the armed forces special powers in areas declared 'disturbed'.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Manipuri
Manipuri dance has two main forms: Jagoi, gentle and graceful (lasya), and Cholom, vigorous (tandava).

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